Promoting Astronomy in Russia

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Research interests: star and planet formation, interstellar medium, astrochemistry, organic matter in the Universe

Professional Astronomy in Russia

- ~1400 astronomers (3 IAU members per 1 million)
- 8 mostly astronomical research institutes
- 9 research institutes with some astronomy
- 17 astronomical (astrophysical) departments at universities

Astronomy locations



Amateur Astronomy and Astronomy for the Public

- Astronomical clubs (sometimes very informal and very small, but nearly in every big town)
- Sidewalk astronomy (sometimes with support from businesses)
- Astronomy children groups
- Amateur astronomy festivals



Astrofest & SibAstro



Astrofest & SibAstro









Planetariums









Involvement of Professional Astronomers

- Open days and tours at observatories
- Mass media: interviews, educational programs, expert opinions, etc.
- Public lectures
- Online courses
- Science festivals
- Popular articles



Special Events

- Solar and lunar eclipses
- Planetary transits
- Comets, meteor showers, etc.





Problems

- A level of astronomical literacy is very low
- People are eager to believe in any myths (Sun is ready to explode, the Earth axis is about to flip, a giant asteroid is about to hit the planet, etc.)
- Language
- Language
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and weather!

- Public involvement in IAU activities is nearly non-existent (NameExoWorld — one proposal, rejected)

ECTORY

Now we have 4 organisations in the directory

LOCATIONS: Russian Federati

CATEGORIES: All

Tags: astronomy, education

Astrospace Association Sirius-86 (Астрокосмическая ассоциация Сириус-86)

Location	Russian Federation, Rezh	http://vgolendukhins86.wix.com/sirius86	
Members	50 - 99	vgolendukhin@yandex.ru	
Staff members	1 - 9		
Students	50 - 99		
Vistors per year	100 - 299		
Language	Russian		

Tags: astronomical enducation

The Zvenigorod House of Children Creativity

Location	Russian Federation, Zvenigorod	http://zvenddt.ru/c_astronomicon.shtml	
Vistors per year	300 - 599	awiebe@mail.ru	
Language	Russian		

Tags: Stargazing,communicating astronomy to the public

Astro-Club Nippy within Amelkin GbR

Location	Russian Federation, Moscow	http://stihi.ru/avtor/nippy	
Admins	1	info@amelkin.de	
Members	1 - 9		
Language	English, German, Russian		

Tags: Astronomy, AstroPoetry, AstroArt,Observation,Literature,Sci-Fi

Solution?

- We plan to organize an associated regional OAD node and a language expertise center

